

KURUKSHETRA: A LIFE · 29 OCTOBER 2026

Art brief: pictures required

Everything from the earlier briefs has been delivered and is in the game: the 29 test stages and the 12 tall fight backgrounds, the 25 16:9 backgrounds, the homeland, festival and journey paintings, the three Mathura paintings and the period repaints. This brief lists what is still needed, in priority order, with a thumbnail of the current picture wherever one exists.

Priority	What	Images	Shape
1 Required	Three fight-background fixes, one portrait fix, the Steam library hero	**5**	9:16, 3:4, 3840×1240
2 Recommended	16:9 fight backgrounds for wide screens; 16:9 versions of the endings, the war days, the charioteer homeland and the nine most-seen scenes	**36**	16:9
3 Optional	16:9 versions of every other scene, event, homeland-life and festival painting	**42**	16:9
Total		**83**	

Not for the artist: the five 1920×1080 Steam screenshots are captured from the game, not painted; Claude can capture them. Advisory and Hindi reviews are reviews, not pictures, and are listed at the end.

RULES

Rules for every image

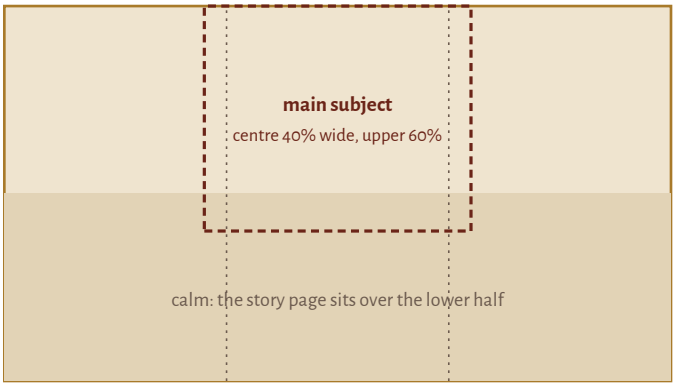
Rule	Detail
Style	Match the paintings already in the game: warm, painterly, detailed early-historic India; golden-hour or lamplit; the same hand as the fair, the homelands, the war days and the test stages.
Extend, don't recompose	A 16:9 version is the same painting as today's 3:1 banner, extended (more sky above, more ground below) with the same scene, light and figures. Repaint at 16:9 in the same style only where extending fails.
Size	Render at native size, never enlarged from a small image: 16:9 at 2560×1440 (at least 1920×1080); 9:16 at 1080×1920; portraits 3:4 at 900×1200. JPG, sRGB.
No text	No painted words, labels, numbers, signatures, watermarks or banners with writing. The game sets all text so it can be translated.
Period	Timber, brick and stone towns; courtyards, gateways, thatch. No domes, Gothic spires, castle towers, colonnades, Greek or Roman columns, upturned East Asian roofs or later temple spires. Straw or clay targets, never bullseyes. Dice are long four-sided bars, never cubes. No European swords, Greek helmets or muscle cuirasses.
Emblems	Plain cloth banners or simple early-historic emblems (sun, lamp, elephant, bow, lotus). No crescents or stars.
Content	Violence implied: no blood, gore or bodies. No Krishna or other divine figures shown. Draupadi in the dice scenes: show the hall and the court's reaction, never her humiliation. Canon characters need advisory review before public use.
Fight and stage art	No people up close: the game's shadow puppets are the actors. Small, soft distant crowds are fine. Keep the ground band open and level (see layouts B and C).
Rights	Only images made or licensed for this project: no photos, TV-serial stills, comic panels or images found online. Say which pieces are AI-generated; Steam requires disclosure.

LAYOUTS

Where things sit on screen

The puppets, cards and story page are drawn by the game over the painting, so leave their areas open and calm.

A. 16:9 scene painting (2560×1440)

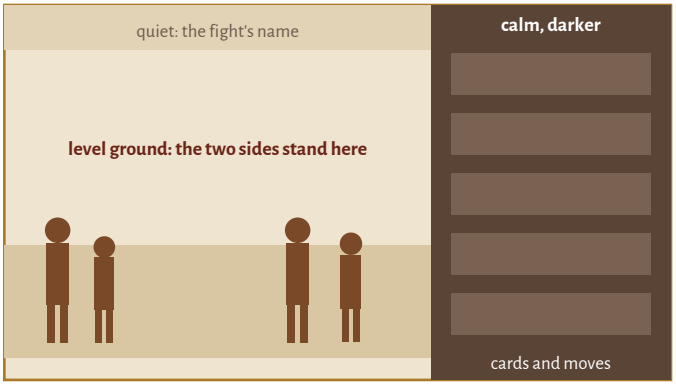


dotted lines: what an upright phone shows

A · 16:9 scene painting

- Used for every 16:9 version in Priorities 2 and 3.
- Keep the main subject in the centre 40% of the width and the upper 60% of the height.
- An upright phone shows only about the centre third of the width.
- Keep the lower half calm (ground, water, floor, a crowd in shadow): the story page lies over it.

B. 16:9 fight background (2560×1440)

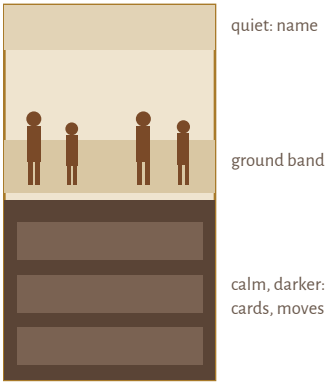


laptops, desktops, tablets held sideways

B · 16:9 fight background

- Used for the 12 new fight backgrounds in Priority 2 (table 2A).
- A level, open ground across the lower third of the left two-thirds: the two sides stand there, two or more figures each.
- The right third calmer and darker: the sides' strength, the last lines of the fight and the moves sit there on cards.
- A quiet strip at the top left for the fight's name.

C. 9:16 fight (1080×1920)



phones

C · 9:16 fight background

- Used for the three tall fight fixes in Priority 1; match the tall fight backgrounds already delivered.
- A quiet top for the fight's name.
- A ground band across the middle, where the figures stand.
- A calm, darker lower half: the cards and moves cover it.

PRIORITY 1 · REQUIRED · 5 IMAGES

Fixes and the Steam hero

Three fight backgrounds and one portrait break the period rules, and the Steam library hero was enlarged from a smaller painting. For the fixes, retouch in place where possible: same file name, same size, same light.



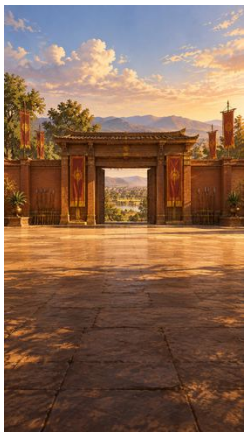
fight_camp_gate_night_tall

Redo · 1080×1920 (9:16) · layout C

Used for: Ashwatthama at the camp gate; standing in his way (the night raid after the war).

What is wrong: The sun is a black eclipse disc with a red ring, which reads as an omen rather than night, and the banners carry crescent-moon emblems.

Paint: The Pandava camp gate at night: a timber gate with a torch on each side, sleeping tents dark beyond, embers in the air. A normal moon or none; plain banners. Ground band across the middle, calm darker lower half. No people.



fight_drupada_yard_tall

Retouch · 1080×1920 (9:16) · layout C

Used for: The raid on Panchala.

What is wrong: The gateway has upturned East Asian eaves, like a Chinese paifang.

Paint: Repaint the gateway only: a gatehouse of timber and brick with a flat or gently sloping roof and carved wooden beams (a torana-like gate). Keep the yard, flagstones, spears and light.



fight_swayamvara_tall

Retouch · 1080×1920 (9:16) · layout C

Used for: The brawl at Draupadi's swayamvara.

What is wrong: The red columns have Greek or Roman capitals and a classical beam above them.

Paint: Repaint the pillars as carved timber pillars with bracket capitals, and the beam as plain timber. Keep the hall, the reflective floor, the lamps and the target pole.



p_abhimanyu

Retouch · 900×1200 (3:4)

Used for: Abhimanyu's portrait: the bonds panel, speakers, allies and the wheel ending.

What is wrong: He wears a Greek muscle cuirass and holds a crested Corinthian helmet.

Paint: Keep his face, age, smile and pose. Replace the armour with early-historic Indian war dress: a quilted cotton or scale-armour jacket over a dhoti, an upper cloth, arm bands, a sword belt. Instead of the helmet, a simple cloth turban or a plain metal cap. Canon character: advisory review.



steam_library_hero

Repaint at native size · 3840×1240 · no text

Used for: The banner across the top of the game's page in Steam libraries.

What is wrong: The current one was enlarged from a smaller painting and is soft up close.

Paint: Two armies facing each other across Kurukshetra at sunrise, banners and chariots, dust in low light (the current composition is right). Paint at 3840×1240. Keep critical content inside the centre 860×380 safe area; the full width is cropped differently on different screens. The game's logo is placed over it at the centre bottom or the left bottom, so keep those areas calm. No text or logo in the image.

PRIORITY 2 · RECOMMENDED · 36 IMAGES

16:9 paintings for wide screens

Tests and fights now play full-screen on their painting, and every scene's painting fills the screen behind the story. Where a 16:9 version exists the game uses it; otherwise it shows the older 3:1 banner, softened, with a blurred fill around it.

2A · Fight backgrounds (12)

New 16:9 versions of the 12 tall fight backgrounds, for laptops, desktops and tablets held sideways (phones keep the tall ones). Same place and light as the tall version shown, recomposed for layout B. Deliver as the name below plus **.jpg** (no _tall). The sparring trial and the night battle already have 16:9 stages. Every prompt ends with: *wide 16:9 painting, painterly Indian epic style, warm light, no people in the foreground, no text, quiet top, level open ground across the lower third of the left two-thirds, calmer and darker right third.*

Tall version	Deliver	Fights	Paint
	fight_war_field.jpg	Day 1; the wheel (day 13); day 16; the last battle (day 18)	Kurukshetra by day: churned earth across the lower third, distant lines of chariots and banners in dust, a pale sky; no bodies or blood
	fight_war_chariot.jpg	Guarding the king; the drive for the king	Around a royal chariot with a white parasol, seen from the side at a distance; dust and banners; the ground clear in front
	fight_war_sunset.jpg	The road to Jayadratha; guarding Jayadratha (day 14)	The battlefield at sunset, the sun low and red, long shadows across a rutted road
	fight_war_camp.jpg	Dushasana's men	The edge of a war camp: tents, spear stacks and banners behind a trampled open space
	fight_camp_gate_night.jpg	Ashwatthama at the gate; standing in his way	The Pandava camp gate at night: a timber gate with a torch on each side, sleeping tents dark beyond, embers in the air; a normal moon or none, plain banners (see Priority 1)
	fight_fair_ring.jpg	Ugra at the fair (wrestling)	A sand wrestling ring at a spring fair: a rope ring on poles, stalls and bunting far behind, crowds tiny and soft

Tall version	Deliver	Fights	Paint
	fight_drupada_yard.jpg	The raid on Panchala	Drupada's palace yard: flagstones, a timber-and-brick gatehouse with a flat or gently sloping roof, guards' spears leaning by the gate
	fight_border_road.jpg	The border villages	A village road at the border: a burning cart, thatched huts, a field on each side, smoke
	fight_swayamvara.jpg	The brawl at the swayamvara	Drupada's swayamvara hall in disorder: overturned seats, garlands on the floor, carved timber pillars and lamps, the target pole high in the middle distance
	fight_forest_road.jpg	After Jayadratha's chariot; bandits on the road	A forest road: a cart track through tall sal trees, dappled light, ferns at the sides
	fight_royal_camp.jpg	The Gandharva ambush	A royal hunting camp in the forest: silk tents, a fire pit, the forest close behind, dusk
	fight_grazing.jpg	Sudatta's men; the cattle raid on Matsya	Open grazing land: a fence across a field, cattle far off in dust, a few trees, wide sky

2B · 16:9 versions of today's paintings (24)

Same painting, extended to 16:9 (layout A). Deliver as the current name plus **_wide.jpg**.

Endings (9): seen at the end of every life

Today (3:1)	Deliver	Scene	Notes
	end_elder_wide.jpg	The wise elder	
	end_forest_wide.jpg	Renunciation	
	end_teller_wide.jpg	The teller	
	end_vengeance_wide.jpg	Vengeance	
	end_survivor_wide.jpg	The homecoming	
	end_broken_wide.jpg	Broken survivor	
	end_river_wide.jpg	The wanderer	
	end_death_wide.jpg	Glorious death; Fallen at Kurukshetra	Keep the lamp emblem on the banner (not a sun); no blood.
	end_wheel_wide.jpg	Into the wheel	Follows Abhimanyu; keep him young and not in Greek armour.

War days (5)

Today (3:1)	Deliver	Scene	Notes
	war_bhishma_wide.jpg	Bhishma commands the Kaurava host	Canon figure: advisory review.
	war_capture_wide.jpg	Drona takes command	Canon figure: advisory review.

Today (3:1)	Deliver	Scene	Notes
	war_day14_wide.jpg	Day 14: a sun that seems to set early; torches across the field	
	war_day15_wide.jpg	Day 15: an elephant named Ashwatthama	
	war_day16_wide.jpg	Day 16: Karna takes command	Karna's face needs advisory review.

Homeland (1)

Today (3:1)	Deliver	Scene	Notes
	home_suta_wide.jpg	The charioteers' lane, after the family moves to Hastinapura; also character creation	The only homeland panorama without a 16:9 version.

Most-seen scenes (9)

Today (3:1)	Deliver	Scene	Notes
	scene_cattle_wide.jpg	Dust on the river road; royal tents near the forest; the far bank	Used by four scenes.
	scene_years_remain_wide.jpg	Before dawn; the night after the dice game	
	scene_smith_wide.jpg	A forge at dawn (Charu)	Also fix: Charu is drawn as a woman with a bun, but the game leaves Charu open; match the portrait p_charu (short curly hair, androgynous). Fix the 3:1 too.
	scene_secret_wide.jpg	Before the Kuru court; below the palace walls	
	scene_raid_wide.jpg	Fire in the sleeping camp	Violence implied only.
	scene_path_wide.jpg	Your years of training	Keep the straw target.
	scene_lake_wide.jpg	A still lake in the heat; the voice waits	

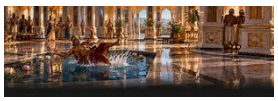
Today (3:1)	Deliver	Scene	Notes
	scene_jayadratha_wide.jpg	An empty hermitage	
	scene_drupada_wide.jpg	The road to Drupada's capital	Keep the low walled town from the repaint.

PRIORITY 3 · OPTIONAL · 42 IMAGES

16:9 versions of everything else

The remaining paintings each appear in one or two scenes, or only in some lives. Same rules as 2B: extend to 16:9 (layout A), deliver as the current name plus **_wide.jpg**. Any order; partial batches are fine.

Story scenes (16)

Today (3:1)	Deliver	Scene	Notes
	scene_journey_wide.jpg	Age 7: the road to Hastinapura	
	scene_ekalavya_wide.jpg	A clay image in a forest clearing	
	scene_sage_wide.jpg	A dusty road at noon	
	scene_ashram_wide.jpg	A hermitage in the mountains	
	scene_birth_wide.jpg	The river where a basket once floated	Keep the low riverbank roofs from the repaint.
	scene_rajasuya_wide.jpg	The hall that Maya built	No colonnades or domes.
	scene_pasha_wide.jpg	Dice under a striped awning	Long bar dice.
	scene_dice_question_wide.jpg	The question no one answers	Draupadi: the court's reaction only; advisory review.
	scene_dice_cloth_wide.jpg	The cloth that does not end	Draupadi: never her humiliation; no divine figure; advisory review.
	scene_envoy_wide.jpg	Thirteen years, gone	
	scene_vow_wide.jpg	Lamps on the dark river	Keep the plain shrines from the repaint.

Today (3:1)	Deliver	Scene	Notes
	scene_armour_wide.jpg	Karna at his morning prayers	Karna: advisory review.
	scene_vasu_wide.jpg	A lamp in a tent	Keep the Indian sword.
	scene_arrows_wide.jpg	A bed of arrows at dusk	
	scene_duryodhana_wide.jpg	A broken king by the water	
	scene_note_wide.jpg	A doorway after the war	

Chance events (10)

Today (3:1)	Deliver	Scene	Notes
	ev_bandits_wide.jpg	Five men in the trees	
	ev_bard_wide.jpg	Under the village banyan	
	ev_deer_wide.jpg	A clearing in the forest	
	ev_flood_wide.jpg	The river over its banks	
	ev_horses_wide.jpg	Northern horses at the river road	
	ev_lamps_wide.jpg	Lamps on every wall	
	ev_letter_wide.jpg	A palm-leaf letter	

Today (3:1)	Deliver	Scene	Notes
	ev_riddle_wide.jpg	An ascetic by the road	
	ev_snake_wide.jpg	The well-house at noon	
	ev_teacher_wide.jpg	A lamp by a sickbed	

The people you came from (8)

Today (3:1)	Deliver	Scene	Notes
	roots_hastinapura_wide.jpg	Hastinapura	Keep the timber-and-brick fort from the repaint.
	roots_panchala_wide.jpg	Panchala	
	roots_matsya_wide.jpg	Matsya	
	roots_mathura_wide.jpg	Mathura	
	roots_anga_wide.jpg	Anga (Champa)	
	roots_suta_wide.jpg	The charioteers' lane	
	roots_nishada_wide.jpg	The Nishada village	
	roots_gandhara_wide.jpg	Gandhara	

Homeland festivals (8)

Today (3:1)	Deliver	Scene	Notes
	custom_hastinapura_wide.jpg	The king's procession	
	custom_panchala_wide.jpg	Children's archery games at Kampilya	
	custom_matsya_wide.jpg	The cattle festival	
	custom_mathura_wide.jpg	Lamps on the Yamuna	
	custom_anga_wide.jpg	Elephant day at Champa	
	custom_suta_wide.jpg	Blessing the horses	
	custom_nishada_wide.jpg	The first hunt	
	custom_gandhara_wide.jpg	Horse fair in the high valley	

ALSO

Not for the artist

- **Steam screenshots (5).** 1920×1080 captures of real play: a scene with its painting and story, an archery test on its painting, a board game, a fight, an ending. Captured from the game, not painted.
- **Advisory review.** Canon portraits; every living painting (faces, hands, canon figures); Draupadi in the dice and exile images; the key art; Karna's face in war_day16 and war_day17.
- **Hindi logo.** A native reader's check of logo_hi.

Delivery

- Name every file exactly as in the tables: a fix keeps its current name; a 16:9 scene is the current name plus **_wide.jpg**; a 16:9 fight is the name in table 2A plus **.jpg**.
- Upload to **art_review/** in the GitHub repo (one folder per batch), or attach a zip in the chat. Partial batches are fine; Priority 1 first.
- The game uses each picture as soon as it arrives and keeps the current one until then.
- Include a note of which pieces are AI-generated and which tool made them, for the Steam disclosure.

Checklist before sending

☐	Native size, the right shape: 16:9 at 2560×1440, 9:16 at 1080×1920, 3:4 at 900×1200, the hero at 3840×1240
☐	JPG, sRGB; 16:9 under 1 MB, 9:16 under 600 KB, portraits under 300 KB
☐	Same scene, light and figures as today's painting (16:9 versions)
☐	Layout respected: subject in the centre and upper area, calm lower half (A); open ground and a calm right third (B); ground band across the middle (C)
☐	No text, signatures or watermarks
☐	Period details right: no domes, spires, colonnades, Greek columns or helmets, East Asian roofs, crescents, bullseyes, cube dice or European swords
☐	No blood or gore; no divine figures; Draupadi shown with dignity
☐	Made or licensed for this project; AI use noted